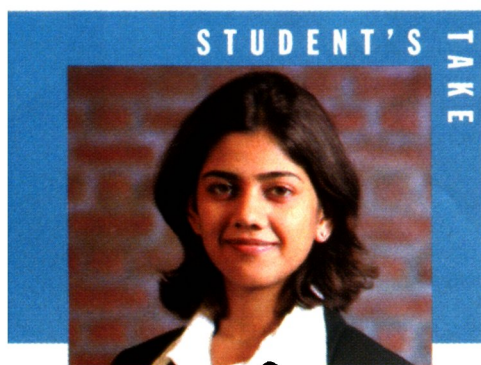




DEEPAK G PAWAR

FUTURE MANAGERS: Campus interviews at IIM-Bangalore



“In an MBA, networking is crucial, especially when you are planning to start your own venture.”

VANI KABRA
IIM-Ahmedabad alumna

dents are taking a hit on their current salary. They are consciously looking for evolution from functional management to general management role or a movement from one industry into another, not salaries,” he says. Adds N.M. Kondap, vice-chancellor, Narsee Monjee Institute of Management Studies, Mumbai, “When it comes to students, the days are over when people only looked for compensation. Today we are talking of employability.” The reason for this shift in perspective, he adds, is the realisation that if one is chasing money, there is a strong likelihood of their getting dissatisfied with whatever they have, no matter where they are. This is also getting echoed on the job side. Bright people, today, are after jobs that give them not just money but challenge, a chance to hone their skills, a promising career and top networking opportunities.

But is the lure of money really palling in comparison to other higher pursuits? Maybe not. Akshay Maheshwari, 25, a certified chartered accountant, is headed to Warwick this September for a one-year general MBA programme. He believes it will improve his career prospects and help him build an international network. But then, “bet-

ter prospects and better money are not necessarily mutually exclusive,” he adds. The numbers that are willing to take a cut in salary to pursue better career goals are still few. So while the set of desirables might have stretched a bit, for the new generation, this need not necessarily mean divorce from the pursuit of fat pay cheques.

An MBA has emerged as the most bankable qualification, and streams like medicine and engineering have already started feeling the pinch. A study conducted by Professor Harish Choudhary at the Department of Management Studies, Indian Institute of Technology-Delhi, reveals that the total applicant pool for medicine had progressively gone down over the last few years. Medicine was being perceived as time-consuming in which the consequent opportunity cost was too high. At the same time, return-on-investment was hardly healthy by any standard. On the other hand, an MBA promised all this and more. At the IIM-Bangalore, of the 1.71 lakh students who applied to the institute last year, 48.39 per cent came from engineering, 11.56 per cent from the sciences, 4.96 per cent from the arts and humanities, 5.54 per cent from computer sciences, 20